



Amazon's set-top box

Amazon is approaching game developers for providing content on their upcoming set-top box
<http://dgit.in/1akoAiW>

Cookies are history

Google is reportedly working on a new technology to track user's browsing habits
<http://dgit.in/18mLLYM>

Scripting with Google Apps Script

Learn how to make Google your personal automation slave

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How would you like to 'do more with Google'? Would you like to send customized e-mails, schedule conferences, build web apps and automate tasks without having to download another software or client for it? If yes, then simply increase the power of your favorite Google apps — like Calendar, Docs, Drive, Gmail, and Sheets with Google Apps Script. Apps Script runs on a JavaScript platform, entirely on cloud which essentially means that the programmer just needs a web browser and an active internet connection to be able to build and run programs without any other hardware requirements.

Prerequisites

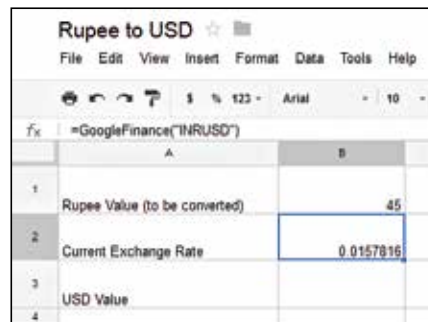
For a developer with a basic grasp on using user inputs as objects, the possibilities are endless. But if you aren't well acquainted with any ECMAScript based language such as C or Java, you should start there. If you're new to JavaScript, MDN's JavaScript wiki has a lot of information. Apart from knowledge in JavaScript, a supported browser and a Google account or Google Apps account are essential.

Getting Started

Surely you must know by now, the indispensability of Google's products (including of course the search engine) - The functions defined in Apps Script have the power to utilize any of Google's APIs such as the Maps API to compute distance and the Calendar API to schedule events. As JavaScript is a web-based language, it is



Create a spreadsheet for your convertor



The exchange rate is pulled from Google

type-insensitive and does not demand the type of the return value as C or Java would. However, good practices such as writing the function name in camel-case, using 'var' to declare variables, ending each statement with a semi-colon and returning a value even if it is null are essential in the open-source community to be able to share your work and maintain a standard.

There are a variety of scripts available for web apps, Google site gadgets, etc. but a good place to start would definitely be

Spreadsheet Custom Functions. A Custom function generally looks something like Fig.1

Follow the steps given below to start scripting with Google Apps Script:

1. Open Google Docs
2. Create New -> Spreadsheet.
3. Go to Tools -> Script Editor
4. Code the functions using JavaScript in the text-editor provided.
5. Save your work.

Using a custom function in a Spreadsheet is very similar to using built-in Spreadsheet formulas and functions which can be found over at <http://goo.gl/hMYwWE>. Just by using the syntax of `=customFunctionName(cell_range)`, you can insert values in your spreadsheet. If you instead get the error message `"#NAME?"` in the cell then the spreadsheet cannot find the function.

Custom functions can read data from the current Spreadsheet and can call anonymous services such as SOAP, UrlFetch and Google Translate, which do not require user credentials to run. However, custom functions are not permitted to access user-specific services. A user-specific service is a service that is tied to a particular user and may access private data, such as Google Calendar, or may act as the user, performing tasks such as sending email.

```
function customFunctionName(arg1, arg2, ..., argN) {
  // The code for your custom function goes here
  ...
  // The value you return here will be displayed in the cell in the Spreadsheet
  // in which the custom function is entered
  return someValue;
}
```

Fig.1 What a custom function looks like